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Sending Return-Home Belongings and Household Goods from the UK to South Korea

When returning to South Korea after studying abroad or completing an overseas work assignment, the belongings you need to ship can vary—from a few boxes of everyday items to the furniture in your home.

Worldlink Express reviews the quantity and dimensions of your belongings, your return schedule, and the work required for packing and delivery, then **recommends a suitable option between air and sea freight**. You can consult us about anything from self-packed return-home belongings to a professionally packed household move that includes furniture.

[Request a quote for return-home shipping or a household move](#)



Air & sea freight

Compare methods for your shipment



Boxes to household moves

Discuss packing and furniture



Know the service scope

Collection, clearance and delivery

Which Is Better: Air or Sea Freight?

You can consider air freight for items you will need immediately after arriving in South Korea, and sea freight for bulky furniture or everyday belongings that you do not need urgently.

Shipping method	When to consider it	What to check in the quote
Air freight	Relatively small quantities of clothing, books, and everyday items, or items you need to receive first	Actual weight and volumetric weight; the scope of collection, customs clearance, and delivery
Sea freight: LCL	Several boxes and some furniture that do not fill an entire container	Volume after packing, minimum freight charges, and destination charges in South Korea
Sea freight: FCL	A large quantity of belongings from an entire home, including furniture and appliances	Container type; packing, loading and unloading, and final delivery arrangements

LCL is a method in which you share container space with other shipments, while FCL is a method in which goods are transported on a container basis.

It is difficult to determine which method is more economical from the number of boxes alone. **It is important to compare options using the dimensions and weight after packing, with destination charges included.** You can also consult us about sending urgently needed items by air and the remaining belongings by sea.

Please check the shipping schedule, including collection, loading for transport, customs clearance, and final delivery. The estimated arrival date may change depending on flight or vessel schedules and local handling conditions.

From Self-Packed Boxes to Professionally Packed Moves Including Furniture

Self-Packed Return-Home Belongings

This option is suitable for customers who want to pack and ship clothing, books, and everyday items themselves. Tell us the dimensions and weight of each box and its main contents, and we will explain the shipping methods and shipment acceptance requirements.

Use sturdy boxes. For heavy items such as books, it is advisable to divide them among smaller boxes. Please confirm the packing specifications and weight limits before booking.

Professionally Packed Moves Including Furniture

You can consult us about packing furniture and household belongings, collection in the UK, and delivery in South Korea together. Please provide photographs and dimensions of the furniture, the floor levels at the collection and delivery addresses, and whether lifts are available.

We also need to check conditions that may affect additional work, such as narrow staircases or doorways and restricted vehicle access. Packing methods and staffing are determined according to the characteristics of the items and the conditions at each location.

Check How Far Delivery Is Included

When comparing quotes, please check which of the following service levels is included.

To the destination port: Customs clearance, handling, and delivery charges after arrival in South Korea are separate.

To the delivery address: Vehicle access conditions and the scope of unloading and carrying items into the property need to be confirmed. Whether a truck-mounted ladder lift or similar equipment is required also needs to be checked.

Inside the home: Check whether delivery into the room, furniture reassembly, and other detailed services are included.

At the quotation stage, Worldlink explains the work you have requested and distinguishes what is included in the service.

Are Return-Home Belongings Exempt from Customs Duty and VAT?

Even previously used household goods are not automatically exempt simply because they are being shipped as return-home belongings. **Customs makes its assessment based on factors such as the period of residence, whether family members accompany you, how long the items have been used, and their quantities.**

For South Korean nationals in general, the categories are as follows.

Category	General overseas residence requirement
Person relocating (이사자)	Having a residence overseas and living there for at least one year
Person relocating with accompanying family (가족을 동반한 이사자)	Having a residence overseas and living there for at least six months
Short-term resident (단기체류자)	Residence of at least three months but less than one year
Short-term resident with accompanying family (가족을 동반한 단기체류자)	Residence of at least three months but less than six months

Detailed conditions apply to the recognition of accompanying family members and the calculation of the residence period. Different criteria, including the intended period of residence in South Korea, apply to foreign nationals and Korean nationals with permanent residence abroad, so please let us know during your consultation.

In general, household goods used for at least three months may qualify for duty and tax exemption, subject to a review of whether they are taxable and other relevant conditions. New products, goods intended for sale, or quantities that are excessive in relation to the size of the household require a separate assessment.

The timing of the shipment's arrival is also important. In principle, you should plan for your shipment to arrive within six months of your own entry into South Korea. Please tell us both your expected return date and when you intend to send your belongings.

Documents Required for Customs Clearance of Household Goods (Some Forms Provided)

Document	What to prepare
Passport copy	Your passport and, where required, the passports of accompanying family members
Household goods import inventory (이사 물품 반입내역서)	The actual items being shipped and their quantities
Statement of reasons for importing household goods (이사물품 사유서)	Complete and sign the form provided
Certificate of Entry and Exit (출입국에 관한 사실증명)	Records that can confirm your period of residence and actual entry history
Box-by-box packing list	Box number, item description, quantity, and whether the items have been used
Additional supporting documents	Proof of residence, family relationship documents, identity-related documents, and other evidence where required

The required documents may vary depending on your nationality, residence history, and whether family members accompany you. We will also explain any power of attorney and transport-related documents in accordance with the applicable procedures.

Numbering your boxes when packing and using the same numbers on your packing list makes it easier to prepare the documents and organise your belongings after arrival.

How Are Return-Home Moving Costs Calculated?

In addition to international freight charges, the cost of a return-home move varies depending on **collection, packing, destination handling in South Korea, and the scope of final delivery.**

Cost item	Conditions that affect the amount
Collection in the UK	Collection location, shipment volume, vehicle access, and required personnel
Packing work	Types of items, furniture dimensions, packing materials, and scope of work
International freight	Chargeable weight for air freight, or volume and container arrangements for sea freight
Destination handling and customs clearance in South Korea	Shipping method and customs clearance procedures
Delivery within South Korea	Delivery area, floor level, and work required, including carrying items inside the home
Other costs	Storage, inspection, special equipment, and other services where required

Example Cost Breakdown

The amounts below are hypothetical and are intended to explain the calculation method. They are not actual Worldlink prices.

Item	Hypothetical amount
Collection in the UK	£60
Packing work	£100
International freight	£450
Destination handling and customs clearance in South Korea	£150
Final delivery	£120
Total	£880

This example does not include taxes, storage charges, inspection charges, or special equipment costs. An actual quote will be provided after we confirm the quantity of your belongings and the working conditions.

Exemption for household goods is separate from transport and customs clearance service charges. Even if your goods qualify for exemption, handling, customs clearance, and delivery charges that are not included in the quote may still arise.

Frequently Asked Questions

How Many Boxes Make Sea Freight More Economical?



Rather than a fixed number of boxes, you need to compare the packed volume and weight, including destination charges in South Korea. Send us the dimensions and weight of each box, and we will review which option—air or sea freight—is suitable.

Can I Send My Belongings Before I Arrive in South Korea?



We need to check the shipping schedule together with your entry date. Please consult us before booking so that we can consider the proof of entry required for household goods customs clearance and the timing of the shipment's arrival.

Can I Ship Furniture or Antiques?



You can consult us about individual items. Send us photographs, dimensions, materials, and values, and we will review the packing method and whether the items can be shipped. Items requiring special handling or separate import requirements need to be checked in advance.

Can I Also Consult You About Moving from South Korea to the UK?



Yes. You can consult us about professionally packed moves in both directions between the UK and South Korea. Imports into the UK are subject to different customs criteria from those for a return-home move to South Korea.

Send Us Your Return Schedule and List of Belongings

Provide the following information, and we will start by explaining what is needed for a quote.

- ✓ Your expected return date and preferred collection period
- ✓ The collection postcode in the UK and delivery area in South Korea
- ✓ The number of boxes, and the dimensions and weight of each box
- ✓ A list of furniture and photographs
- ✓ Required services, such as packing and carrying items inside the home
- ✓ Floor levels, lift availability, and vehicle access conditions at both the collection and delivery addresses

Prepare for your return-home move by choosing a shipping method that suits the quantity of your belongings and your schedule, and checking which costs are included in the quote.

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